[METRIC]

A-A-1252B
February 11, 1992
SUPERSEDING
A-A-1252A
September 16, 1986

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

PAD (MEAT, POULTRY & FISH)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

This Commercial Item Description covers paper pads used in the prepacking of meat, poultry and fish products.

Classification: The pads shall be of the following Types, as specified (see 6.b).

Type I - Low absorbency
Type II - High absorbency

1. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS:

A. Construction. Type - I pads shall be made from water resistant top sheet with sufficient amount of plies of absorbent paper wadding. Type - II pads shall consist of sufficient amount of plies of absorbent paper wadding, with polyolefin film on both sides. Both Types shall conform to the applicable requirements of this commercial item description and all applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act Food Additive Amendment, 21 CFR Paragraphs 176 & 177. The pads shall be furnished in the form of sheets, perforated to provide individual pads. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.c), the color of the pads shall be white.

B. Dimensions. The dimensions of the pad shall be as specified (see 6.b), with the tolerances of ± 6 mm (± 1/4").

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A: Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

FSC 8540

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:12Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

C. Physical Requirements. The pads shall conform to the physical requirements listed in Table I below:

TABLE I

Characteristics		Requirement	Test Method
Basis Weight for Type - I only, min		40.7 g/m^2 (25 lb$_m$ - 24"x36"- 500 sheets)	TAPPI T 410
Water Resistance for Type - I only		40 minutes minimum	TAPPI T 433
Thickness (polyolefin film)		0.010 mm minimum (0.0004 inch minimum)	TAPPI T 411
Acidity (ph value)		5.5 to 9.0	TAPPI T 509
Odor		No odor	TAPPI T 483
Absorbency	Type I	12 grams minimum	par. 2.C below
	Type II	40 grams minimum	

D. Workmanship. The pad shall not permanently stick to food or tray while preventing leakage of package. The pads shall not fall apart when wet or when removed from the tray, and shall not exhibit any dirt, tears or discoloration. The pads shall be free of any defects adversely affecting its appearance or serviceability.

2. QUALITY ASSURANCE:

A. Responsibility for Inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the Commercial Item Description, where such inspection are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

B. Sampling. Samples shall be selected for inspection in accordance with MIL-STD-105 using the plans described in Table II. A lot shall consist of a number of pads manufactured by the same process from the same components at the same time. Random samples shall be drawn from each lot for the end item inspection. Unless otherwise specified, every lot shall be tested.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:12Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Table II

Inspection	Inspection Level	AQL (%) defective	Sample Unit	Requirement Paragraph/s
Construction	S-4	4.0	1 Pad	1A
Dimensions	S-4	4.0	1 Pad	1B
Physical Requirements	S-2	2.5	1 Pad	1C
Workmanship	S-4	4.0	1 Pad	1D
Packaging Packing & Marking	S-2	4.0	1 Shipping Container	4

C. Absorbency test. Measure the dry weight of the pad in grams. Lay the pad in the pan of distilled water for 60 ± 5 seconds. Then, grasp the pad with the tweezers by the corner edge, remove it from the water and hold it vertically for 60 ± 5 seconds. Measure the final weight of the pad. Subtract the dry weight from the final weight to obtain the total absorbency per pad.

3. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS: The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, to the maximum extent practicable.

4. PACKAGING, PACKING AND MARKING: Packaging, packing and marking shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order.

5. REFERENCED DOCUMENTS: The issue of the referenced documents in effect on the date of the solicitation for offers or request for proposals shall be used to determine conformance with the requirements of this Commercial Item Description.

A. Public Law:

Public Law 94-580 - Resource Conservation and Recovery Act (Part of U.S. Code, Title 42)

Copies of the U.S. Code may be obtained through the Congressional Sales Office, U.S Government Printing Office, Washington D.C. 20402.

B. Federal Laws and Regulations:

21 CFR - Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act, Food Additive Amendment: Paragraph 177.1520

Application for copies should be addressed to the Department of Health, Education, and Welfare, 330 Independence Avenue, S.W., Washington DC, 20003.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:12Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

A-A-13528

C. Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

MIL-STD-105 is available from Naval Publication and Forms Center; 5801 Tabor Avenue; and Materials; Philadelphia, PA 19120.

D. Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry (TAPPI):

T 410 - Weight Per Unit Area (Basis Weight or Substance) of Paper and Paperboard.
T 411 - Thickness (Caliper) of Paper and Paperboard and liningboard.
T 433 - Water Resistance of Sized Paper and Paperboard (Dry Indicator Method).
T 483 - Odor of Packaging Materials.
T 509 - Hydrogen ion concentration (pH) of paper extracts (cold extraction method)

TAPPI standard test methods can be obtained from Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry; Technology Park/Atlanta; P.O. Box 105113; Atlanta, Ga 30348.

6. ORDERING DATA: The following shall be included in the contract or purchase order.

(a). Number, title and date of this commercial item description.
(b). Type and dimensions of the pad (length by width).
(c). Color (If other than white required).
(d). Packaging, packing and marking required.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Military Coordinating Activity

Army - GL

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA

Review Activity

Army - MD

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

GSA - FSS

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:12Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.